Christian Johansen

Senior Engineering Manager

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SUMMARY

Senior Engineering Manager at Solace Health leading the Communications, Agentic, and Core platform teams (3 technical leads and about 20 engineers). Joined as an engineer in 2023 and built the Solace Line, the phone and SMS system advocates use to reach patients, which now handles over 30,000 calls a day. Still hands-on in TypeScript, NestJS, React Native, and PostgreSQL. I care most about reliable systems, clear ownership between teams, and helping engineers grow.

EXPERIENCE

Solace Health September 2023 – Present

Senior Engineering Manager, Communications, Agentic & Core Platform · [Month] 2026 – Present

Started as a Software Engineer; promoted to Senior Software Engineer, Technical Lead, then Senior Engineering Manager

Leadership

- Lead about 20 engineers through 3 technical leads who report to me, across the Communications, Agentic (AI patient outreach), and Core platform teams. Communications covers voice, video, SMS/MMS, fax, and call transcription.
- Improve our engineering hiring process, and run talent reviews, performance reviews, and career development for my groups.
- Define how projects move through their lifecycle across teams and departments, and how those groups work together along the way.
- Hold regular skip-level meetings with engineers across my groups to keep a pulse on engineering culture, and use what I hear to find where process should be introduced or improved.

As Technical Lead

- Helped set quarterly roadmaps based on engineering needs and priorities, and supported product-led initiatives through their project lifecycle with technical guidance on each project.
- Turned Communications Core into a service core that provides data access and communication features to other cores, and defined how other cores can adopt the same model when their domain ownership fits it. This included ownership agreements, a separate repo with CODEOWNERS, and documentation standards with a reusable template for each domain.
- Interviewed engineering candidates at every stage, from reviewing take-home coding assessments and running initial technical screens to leadership behavioral interviews and final onsite interviews.

Technical work

- Built the Solace Line, which gives every advocate their own masked Twilio number with calling, forwarding schedules, voicemail, conference calls, recordings, and two-way SMS/MMS. It became advocates' main way to reach patients and now handles over 30,000 calls a day.
- Led the Twilio Stability project. Moved database work off the live call path using CQRS-style read/write separation, Redis read projections, and Bull queues, then put Twilio jobs on their own queues after a vendor outage. Along with a database tier upgrade, this cut p95 webhook response times 32–58% across webhook types while webhook volume grew about 70%, and reduced hours with any webhook over Twilio's 15-second timeout by about 90%.
- Led the initiative to build the first internal SDK for an engineering group, bringing the whole communications domain into one package with extensive test coverage and observability.
- Shipped AI call transcription with Deepgram, including speaker labels and auto-generated tasks and SOAP notes for advocates and physicians.
- Set up Datadog monitoring for the communications stack (APM span tags, log-based metrics, webhook dashboards, and trace correlation across requests) and led the team's push to reduce Sentry errors.
- Migrated a high-volume transcript table (400M+ rows, growing about 1.5M a day) with zero downtime, cutting its average query time about 97% (roughly 35ms to 1ms), shrinking storage per row about 77%, and reclaiming about 145GB of disk. Also tuned queries and indexes on the call history endpoints.
- Ran incident response during a major Twilio outage in 2026, including recovering transcripts for affected calls.

- Moved telehealth video from Jitsi to Dyte, with cloud recording and transcription webhooks, then rebuilt it again on Zoom.

Earlier at Solace

- Automated advocate payouts in Stripe, replacing a manual process with scheduled jobs and Slack alerts.
- Worked with the growth team to get intake funnel conversion above 80%. Rebuilt the funnel in XState and added live Medicare and insurance eligibility checks.
- Built clinical tools including e-prescribing (Photon), health record ingestion (CommonWell), CPT/ICD-10 coding, and a practitioner dashboard. Turned Figma designs into reusable React components.

bash.gg · Full-Stack Engineer June 2022 – September 2023

- Helped make design, infrastructure, and release decisions for a React Native app with a Node.js/Express backend.
- Designed the PostgreSQL schema and built 100+ REST API endpoints for the core product.
- Managed AWS deployments with Terraform and set up CI/CD in GitHub Actions.

Neon · Full-Stack Engineer November 2021 – July 2022

- Built the NFT purchase, mint, and delivery flow on Solana using Circle payments and web3.js.
- Wrote Node.js REST APIs that integrated Firebase, Sanity CMS, and Solana.
- Worked with designers to build React components from Figma designs.

Moonfarmer · Software Engineer (Contract) October 2021 – December 2021

- Built reusable React components in Storybook that were shared across several client projects.
- Wrote REST endpoints integrating with Strapi CMS.

Spectra Logic · Systems Support Technician November 2015 – November 2018

- Worked incident tickets by digging through logs to find root causes, and wrote clear resolution summaries for customers while keeping satisfaction high.
- Trained and mentored junior technicians, often troubleshooting side by side.

SKILLS

- **Leadership:** team management, hiring, talent reviews, roadmap planning, cross-team ownership, incident management, technical writing
- **Languages:** TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, HTML/CSS
- **Backend:** Node.js, NestJS, Express, REST APIs, CQRS, event-driven architecture, transactional outbox
- **Frontend & mobile:** React, React Native, Next.js, XState, Tailwind, shadcn/ui
- **Data:** PostgreSQL, TypeORM, Prisma, Drizzle, Redis, Bull/BullMQ, Redis Streams
- **Communications & AI:** Twilio (Voice, Messaging, Conferences, Trust Hub), Dyte, Deepgram, Socket.IO, Documo (fax)
- **Integrations:** Stripe, Photon (e-Rx), CommonWell, Customer.io
- **Observability & infra:** Datadog APM, distributed tracing, Sentry, Docker, AWS, GCP, Terraform, GitHub Actions
- **Domain:** healthcare, HIPAA and PHI handling, Medicare eligibility, clinical documentation

EDUCATION

- **Hack Reactor**, Advanced Software Engineering
- **University of Massachusetts Amherst**, B.S. Psychology